

CAMBRIDGE INTERNATIONAL EXAMINATIONS

Cambridge International General Certificate of Secondary Education

MARK SCHEME for the October/November 2014 series

0500 FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/32

Paper 3 (Directed Writing and Composition),
maximum raw mark 50

This mark scheme is published as an aid to teachers and candidates, to indicate the requirements of the examination. It shows the basis on which Examiners were instructed to award marks. It does not indicate the details of the discussions that took place at an Examiners' meeting before marking began, which would have considered the acceptability of alternative answers.

Mark schemes should be read in conjunction with the question paper and the Principal Examiner Report for Teachers.

Cambridge will not enter into discussions about these mark schemes.

Cambridge is publishing the mark schemes for the October/November 2014 series for most Cambridge IGCSE[®], Cambridge International A and AS Level components and some Cambridge O Level components.

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Note: All Examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the passage.

Section 1: Directed Writing

Question 1

This question tests Writing Objectives W1–W5 (15 marks):

- articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined
- order and present facts, ideas and opinions
- understand and use a range of appropriate vocabulary
- use language and register appropriate to audience and context
- make accurate and effective use of paragraphs, grammatical structures, sentences, punctuation and spelling.

AND aspects of Reading Objectives R1–R3 (10 marks):

- understand and collate explicit meanings
- understand, explain and collate implicit meanings and attitudes
- select, analyse and evaluate what is relevant to specific purposes.

Imagine that you are Elena and you are going to answer Freya's letter.

Write your letter, which will be published in the magazine.

In your letter you should:

- identify and evaluate Freya's arguments and concerns
- give Freya suitable advice for her situation.

Base your letter on what you have read in the passage, but be careful to use your own words. Begin your letter, 'Dear Freya, I was sad to read your letter and I understand your feelings. However, I am sure that your situation is not as hopeless as you imagine...'

You should write between 1½ to 2 sides allowing for the size of your handwriting. Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 15 marks for the quality of your writing.

[25]

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General notes on likely content:

The best responses show sympathy to Freya but try to persuade her that her attitude is rather selfish; the advice is to change the direction of her life. There is some skill in selecting which of the content to evaluate, but there is plenty of detail from the text.

Average responses tend to summarise Freya's arguments and concerns and the best of these are well ordered. However, the quality of the advice is less good and individual suggestions are rather brief.

Weaker responses tend to summarise some of the text in no particular order, lift parts of the reading material or write irrelevantly, drifting away from the passage.

Candidates might use the following ideas:

Responses may include a wide range of points of which the following are examples:

Identification of Freya's arguments

- She and her husband have sacrificed their lives to bring Jacob up
- Jacob's actions in leaving home are unnecessary
- He is ungrateful, thoughtless and selfish
- What he is doing is risky, and here there is security
- Her role as a mother and grandparent is being taken away
- She and her husband are getting older and will be isolated from everybody

Suitable advice: Give credit for an appropriate mix of sympathy for both Freya and Jacob.

- Let Jacob go and promise your support for his ventures
- Perhaps this is a knee-jerk reaction and with time your attitudes will change
- Make sure that you are able to keep in touch via the internet – he will teach you
- Stop being sorry for yourself and thinking you are getting old
- Go on a holiday, and trust your two workers to look after it in your absence
- Be less grudging about welcoming Jacob's family. The grandchildren will make you feel young again.
- Find time to socialise with your neighbouring farmers
- Talk to Jacob unselfishly about the whole situation and about his inheritance to discover his real views

They may also explore ideas such as:

- Freya's reaction – She has given far too much and needs to look at her life anew.
- Jacob has every right to take the course he has decided on.

Accept other relevant ideas derived from the passage and relevant to the question.

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The question is marked out of 10 for Reading and 15 for Writing.

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading.

Band 1	9–10	Gives a thorough, perceptive, convincing evaluation. Reads effectively between the lines. Shows understanding by developing much of the reading material and assimilating it into a response to the task.
Band 2	7–8	Some evidence of evaluation, engaging with a few of the main points with success. Uses reading material to support the argument. Occasionally effective development of ideas in the material.
Band 3	5–6	Reproduces a number of points to make a satisfactory response. The response covers the material adequately, but may miss opportunities to develop it relevantly or at length.
Band 4	3–4	Selects points from the passage rather literally and/or uses the material thinly. Does not combine points into a connected response.
Band 5	1–2	Parts of the response are relevant, though the material may be repeated or used inappropriately.
Band 6	0	Response does not relate to question and/or too much unselective copying directly from the material to gain a mark in Band 5.

Use the following table to give a mark out of 15 for Writing.

Band 1	13–15	Consistent sense of audience; authoritative and appropriate style. Fluent, varied sentences; wide range of vocabulary. Strong sense of structure, paragraphing and sequence. Virtually no error.
Band 2	10–12	Sense of audience mostly secure; there is evidence of style and fluency; sentences and vocabulary are effective. Secure overall structure; mostly well-sequenced. Writing is mainly accurate.
Band 3	8–9	Occasional sense of audience; mostly written in correctly structured sentences; vocabulary may be plain but adequate for the task; mostly quite well structured. Errors minor.
Band 4	5–7	Inconsistent style; simple or faultily constructed sentences; vocabulary simple; basic structure. Frequent errors, including sentence separation.
Band 5	3–4	Inappropriate expression; the response is not always well sequenced. Serious errors in sentence structure/vocabulary/grammar/punctuation.
Band 6	1–2	Expression unclear; flawed sentence construction and order. Persistent serious errors interfere with the conveying of meaning.
Band 7	0	Problems of expression and accuracy are too serious to gain a mark in Band 6.

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Section 2: Composition

Questions 2 (a), 2 (b), 3 (a), 3 (b), 4 (a) and 4 (b).

Give two marks:

- the first mark is out of 13 for Content and Structure: see Table A
- the second mark is out of 12 for Style and Accuracy: see Table B

Write about 2 sides, allowing for the size of your handwriting, on **one** of the following:

Argumentative/Discursive writing

- 2 (a)** Would you enjoy being **one** of these: a teacher, a police officer or a doctor? Explain why or why not. [25]

OR

- (b)** 'Getting old is something to be dreaded'. Do you agree? [25]

Descriptive writing

- 3 (a)** Describe a classroom of students with no teacher present. End your description as the classroom door suddenly opens. [25]

OR

- (b)** You climb a tree and cannot be seen. Describe what you see and hear happening below. [25]

Narrative writing

- 4 (a)** Write a story which begins with the words 'Nothing could have prepared me for what I had to do next.' [25]

OR

- (b)** You have the power to go back 24 hours to change what happened or what was said. Write a story involving this power, making it clear why you needed to make changes. [25]

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COMPOSITION TASKS: TABLE A – CONTENT AND STRUCTURE

	ARGUMENTATIVE/ DISCURSIVE TASK	DESCRIPTIVE TASK	NARRATIVE TASK
Band 1 11–13	- Consistently well developed, logical stages in an overall, at times complex, argument. Each stage is linked to the preceding one, and sentences within paragraphs are soundly sequenced.	- There are many well-defined, well-developed ideas and images, describing complex atmospheres with a range of details. Overall structure is provided through devices such as the movements of the persona, the creation of a short time span, or the creation of atmosphere or tension. There is no confusion with writing a story. Repetition is avoided and the sequence of sentences makes the picture clear to the reader.	- The narrative is complex and sophisticated and may contain devices such as sub-texts, flashbacks and time lapses. Cogent details are provided where necessary or appropriate. - Different parts of the story are balanced and the climax carefully managed. Sentence sequences are sometimes arranged to produce effects such as the building up of tension or providing a sudden turn of events.
Band 2 9–10	- Each stage of the argument is defined and developed, although the explanation may not be consistent. - The stages follow in a generally cohesive progression. Paragraphs are mostly well sequenced, although some may finish less strongly than they begin.	- There is a good range of images with interesting details which contribute to a sense of atmosphere. - These are formed into an overall picture of some clarity, largely consistent and effective. There may be occasional repetition, and opportunities for development or the provision of detail may be missed. Sentences are often well sequenced.	- The writing develops some interesting features, but not consistently so. Expect the use of detail and some attention to character or setting. - Writing is orderly and the beginning and ending are satisfactorily managed. The reader is well aware of the climax even if it is not fully effective. Sequencing of sentences provides clarity and engages the reader in events or atmosphere.

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Band 3 7–8	- There is a series of relevant points and a clear attempt is made to develop some of them. These points are straightforward and logical/coherent. - Repetition is avoided, but the order of the stages in the overall argument can be changed without adverse effect. The sequence of the sentences within paragraphs is satisfactory, but the linking of ideas may be insecure.	- There is a selection of relevant ideas, images, and details, which satisfactorily address the task. An attempt is made to create atmosphere. - The description provides a series of points rather than a sense of their being combined to make an overall picture, but some ideas are developed successfully, albeit straightforwardly. Some sentences are well sequenced.	- A straightforward but cohesive story with identification of features such as character and setting. - While opportunities for appropriate development of ideas are sometimes missed, overall structure is competent, and some features of a developed narrative are evident. Sentences are usually sequenced to narrate events clearly.
Band 4 5–6	- Mainly relevant points are made and they are developed partially with some brief effectiveness. - The overall argument shows signs of structure but may be sounder at the beginning than at the end, or may drift away from the topic. There may be some repetition. The sequence of sentences may be occasionally insecure.	- Some relevant ideas are provided and occasionally developed a little, perhaps as a narrative. There are some descriptive details, but the use of event may overshadow them. - There is some overall structure, but the writing may lack direction and intent. There may be interruptions in the sequence of sentences and/or some lack of clarity.	- Responds relevantly to the topic, but is only a series of chronological events with occasional references to character and setting. - Overall structure is sound, but there are examples where particular parts are too long or short. The climax is not effectively described or prepared. Sentence sequences narrate events and occasionally contain irrelevances.

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Band 5 3–4	• A few relevant points are made and may be expanded into paragraphs, but development is very simple and not always logical. • There is weakness of sequencing overall and within paragraphs. Paragraphing is inconsistent. Repetition and an inability to sustain relevant argument are obvious.	• Content is relevant but lacking in scope or variety. Opportunities to provide development and detail are frequently missed. • The overall structure, though readily discernible, lacks form and dimension. Paragraphing is inconsistent. The reliance on identifying events, objects and/or people sometimes leads to a sequence of sentences without progression.	• A very simple narrative; it may consist of nonsensical or confusing events. • Unequal or inappropriate importance is given to parts of the story. Paragraphing is inconsistent. Dialogue may be used ineffectively. There is no real climax. Sentence sequences are used only to link simple series of events.
Band 6 1–2	• A few points are discernible but any attempt to develop them is very limited. • Overall argument only progresses here and there and the sequence of sentences is poor.	• Some relevant facts are identified, but the overall picture is unclear and lacks development. • There are examples of sequenced sentences, but there is also repetition and muddled ordering.	• Stories are incoherent and narrate events indiscriminately. Endings are absent or lack effect. • The shape of the narrative is unclear; some of the content has no relevance to the plot. Sequences of sentences are sometimes poor, leading to a lack of clarity.
Band 7 0	• Rarely relevant, little material, and presented in a disorderly structure. Not sufficient to be placed in Band 6.	• Rarely relevant, little material, and presented in a disorderly structure. Not sufficient to be placed in Band 6.	• Rarely relevant, little material, and presented in a disorderly structure. Not sufficient to be placed in Band 6.

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COMPOSITION TASKS: TABLE B: STYLE AND ACCURACY

Band 1	11–12	Writing is consistent, stylistically fluent, linguistically strong and accurate; has sense of audience. Look for: • appropriately used ambitious words • complex sentence structures where appropriate
Band 2	9–10	Writing is mostly fluent, sometimes linguistically effective and largely accurate; may have some sense of audience. Look for: • signs of a developing style • some ability to express shades of meaning
Band 3	7–8	Writing is clear, competent (if plain) in vocabulary and grammar; errors perhaps frequent, but minor. Look for: • mostly correct sentence separation • occasional precision and/or interest in choice of words
Band 4	5–6	Writing is clear and accurate in places, and uses limited vocabulary and grammar; errors occasionally serious. Look for: • simple sentences • errors of sentence separation
Band 5	3–4	Writing is simple in vocabulary and grammar; errors are distracting and sometimes serious, but overall meaning can be followed. Look for: • definite weaknesses in sentence structures • grammatical errors such as incorrect use of prepositions and tense
Band 6	1–2	Writing is weak in vocabulary and grammar; serious, persistent errors; meaning is blurred. Look for: • faulty and/or rambling sentences • language insufficient to carry intended meaning
Band 7	0	Writing is difficult to follow because of inadequate language proficiency and error.